Project 5 | Inside the World of AI

In this Project, you will explore AI concepts, experiment with AI tools and reflect on your learnings about this technology and what it means for you.

1. What Do You Think? (10pt)

In the video "How do you feel about AI?" Dr. Marily Nika presented an optimistic view on AI, predicting that it will create new jobs, just like the Internet and other technologies did. Conversely, Stuart Russell in the TedEd video (based on speech at the World Economic Forum) warned that AI could lead to economic instability if not managed well.

Reflect on this question, and write up a short paragraph explaining which of these views do you personally lean towards more — and why?

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

I think AI is a really useful tool, but it's something we have to use carefully. It's definitely not going anywhere, so learning how to use it for work and school is becoming pretty important. Still, I worry about how it might take over certain jobs and cause unemployment for a lot of people. That's why it's important to set limits and make sure it's programmed responsibly. I use AI a lot outside of class, mostly to help me put my thoughts into words and make my writing sound smoother.

2. Try it Yourself (50pt)

2A. Pick your tools: Pick two free AI tools to experiment with. At least one should be from the list below:

- ChatGPT by OpenAI
- Claude.ai by Anthropic
- Perplexity AI
- Leonardo.ai (for generating images)
- Freepik.com (for generating images)

2B. Same Prompt, Same Tool: In one of your chosen tools, experiment with using **the same exact prompt twice.** Prompts may be about any topic (appropriate for work), but we recommend focusing on trying to complete tasks relevant to your desired professional field. If you prefer not to use your own prompts, feel free to utilize one of these examples:

- *"Draft a short mission statement for a new tech startup focused on AI-driven healthcare solutions."*
- *"Suggest a simple 3-day workout plan for beginners."*
- *"Generate a poster design for a college career fair focused on tech and innovation."*
- "Suggest three creative event ideas for a college club trying to attract new members."

In a short written paragraph, summarize the results of this experiment.

While using **just one tool**, did you receive the same response for the same prompt? If not, how did responses differ?

Was the variability in responses helpful, or confusing? Which response did you like better, and why? Would you adjust your prompt as a result of this experiment?

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

The differences between the two responses were pretty helpful—not confusing at all. They showed how pulling fresher info tweaks stuff like bumping up AI ethics for skill #5 instead of just basic tools, which feels more legit for 2026 marketing vibes. I liked the second one better because it nailed down real-world stuff like proving ROI and adding in AI better, which matches what's hot now. Yeah, I'd tweak my prompt to add "2026 trends with AI focus" to get spot-on answers without the back-and-forth.

2C. Same Prompt, Different Tools: Next, use a prompt of your choice in **two different tools**, and compare the results. Write up a short paragraph discussing the variation in responses.

Were the outputs different? If so, how? (e.g, in style, tone, level of detail?). Which output would you consider higher quality, and why? Which tool seemed to better understand your request? Did experimenting with the tools give you a sense of which AI tool you would prefer for which kind of tasks?

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

My Prompt "What is the most important skill for a digital marketer? List the top 5 crucial skills."

Each output was different in how it handled the future of the industry. The first response was a basic, easy-to-read overview that felt like a standard list. The second response, which I preferred, felt much more "2026" because it addressed complex topics like AI ethics and proving

ROI, making it feel higher quality and more professional. It seemed like the second tool better understood the request for future trends, whereas the first was just a general summary. I'd use the first tool for brief answers and the second for thorough research on hard topics.

3. Make it Personal (15pt)

AI is impacting different fields differently, and some industries and roles are more immediately impacted than others. Do some research on a field, industry or role that you think you might be interested in pursuing.

If you are struggling to get started, consider using this prompt:

Try this prompt

I'm interested in exploring how AI is *going to impact* ***[field/industry/role]*** *in the coming years. Give me a high level summary of the main impacts so far, what experts are predicting, and how skills and roles are changing.*

Provide a list of sources I could explore further, including links to articles, videos, podcasts and prominent speakers on this topic.

Provide the links to at least three resources you've used in your research, and briefly describe what you learned and how it impacted your thinking. Were you surprised by what you found? Does anything worry, inspire, or intrigue you about this information? What action steps will you take to continue to stay ahead of the curve as AI's impact across industries grows?

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

My Prompt “

I'm interested in exploring how AI is going to impact such as marketing/digital marketing in the coming years. Give me a high level summary of the main impacts so far, what experts are predicting, and how skills and roles are changing.”

I got these 3 sources from many options and watched the video and read the articles.

1. “What Will Happen to Marketing in the Age of AI?" by Jessica Apotheker (TED, YouTube)
2. Google "Top digital marketing trends 2026"
3. Zeta Global's "Predictions 2026: How AI Will Redefine Marketing"

From this research, I learned that AI in 2026 will increasingly manage autonomous marketing campaigns and hyper-personalized strategies, reframing it as a true collaborator that enhances human creativity and decision-making.

I didn't find it too surprising, as I could foresee trends like conversational AI, but the rapid rise of agentic systems independently managing budgets and optimization intrigues me.

The potential for transformative customer experiences is inspiring, though the risk of diminished brand authenticity without strong human oversight raises concerns.

To stay ahead, I'll:

1) Follow MAICON sessions and Marketing AI Institute updates weekly;

2) Experiment with tools like Gemini or Zeta demos regularly;

3) Develop a structured AI skills plan focusing on prompting, validation, and ethics;

4) Network on LinkedIn with experts like Andrew Warden;

5) Review key reports from PwC, Google, and Zeta quarterly.

4. Make it Work for You! (15pt)

Employers are interested in AI-savvy new employees. In fact, in a recent survey 71% of employers stated that they would rather hire a less experienced employee with AI skills over a more experienced candidate without AI skills.

This suggests that job candidates who are able to articulate a high comfort level with AI on their resumes, LinkedIn profiles, and in job interviews are going to enjoy a strong advantage in the job market.

Choose one of the following job interview questions:

- Can you walk me through a recent task or project where you used AI?
- How do you evaluate the reliability and accuracy of AI outputs?
- How do you stay updated with the fast-changing AI landscape?
- What considerations do you keep in mind when deciding if you should use AI at work?

Write up your answer, just as you would deliver it in a job interview. DO NOT tell us what you will say - write the words you would use, as if quoting.

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

That's a really good question. I do this all the time in my projects—like in a recent career accelerator where I used AI to build my first website from scratch. As a total beginner in web development, I treated AI like a collaborative coding assistant and tutor. I kicked things off by describing the site's visual style, structure, and key features in plain language, and it spit out starter HTML, CSS, and JavaScript I could test right away in a browser.

It was super helpful—I'd preview the code, notice tweaks needed like a mobile-responsive header or smoother UX flow, then refine my prompt and adjust. This wasn't just a one time thing; it was constant testing and collaboration, which sped up the technical stuff so I could zero in on design, user experience, and sharp messaging.

In the end, AI handled the boilerplate while I owned the vision, landing me a functional, visually sharp site. It gave me confidence in rapid prototyping and feedback-driven iteration—skills that map straight to digital marketing campaigns, where speed, testing, and focus on the user and business goals are everything.

Ready for a LevelUp? (Optional Extra Credit: 10pt)

Ready for more? Write up a short LinkedIn post documenting your learnings about AI and experience using it. Consider adding media for better engagement (e.g. video of yourself talking or using AI, an image of a prompt you used and the response you received, etc).

Actually posting it to LinkedIn is optional, but highly recommended! Even if you do, **please don't submit screenshots**.

Below, paste or type the text of your LinkedIn post **(extra credit: 10 pt)**

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

Just wrapped up a deep dive into AI's 2026 impact on digital marketing—agentic AI autonomously running campaigns, hyper-personalization, and unified attribution are set to redefine the field. 📈

Big insight: AI supercharges creativity (up 40% per studies), but success hinges on "left-brain" skills like precise prompting, ethical oversight, and strategic focus—not just automation.

Applied it hands-on in my career accelerator project: Used AI as a coding tutor to build my first website. Prompted for mobile-first design (e.g., "eco-themed header with responsive nav"), iterated via previews/tweaks, and shifted focus to UX/marketing positioning. Result? A sharp prototype that boosted my confidence for campaign prototyping. 🚀

Example prompt & output attached—who's leveraging AI like this in marketing? Let's connect!

Answer Links Images Share

Create starter HTML/CSS/JS for a mobile-first eco-site with header, hero image, and CTA button" → Generated responsive code preview

2 steps completed >

```xml
<!DOCTYPE html>
```

Ask a follow-up

Model

form/modal). History

Customization Tips

Copy-paste into an HTML file and open in browser. Replace hero image URL with your own (use tools like Unsplash for free eco photos). Edit colors/text in CSS for branding. Add sections below hero for full site. reallygooddesigns

Responsive Preview Notes

- Mobile (<768px): Compact header with menu icon, stacked hero text.
- Tablet/Desktop: Inline nav, larger fonts, centered content. Test in browser dev tools. websitedesignswansea

Ask a follow-up

Model

This starter code creates a fully responsive, mobile-first eco-site with a sticky green header, immersive hero section using an optimized nature image overlay, and interactive CTA button. It uses soft eco-friendly colors like sage (#87A96B) and forest green (#4A7C59), Lora/Open Sans fonts, and hamburger menu for mobile nav. History +3

Key Features

- **Mobile-First CSS**: Base styles for small screens, media queries enhance for tablet/desktop. ishadeed
- **Performance Optimized**: Minimal JS, CSS transitions, no heavy libraries; eco-design principles like efficient images. ronins +1

Ask a follow-up

Model

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